

Meta Doubles Down in Texas – \$10 Billion AI Data Center, 1 GW Power, and a Massive Clean Energy Push

Posted by u/AlphaOneYoutube • • 0 points • 9 comments

<https://skarfinans.com/en/meta-boosts-investment-in-west-texas-ai-data-center-by-over-sixfold-to-10-billion/>

Meta announced Thursday that its investment in the new AI data center in El Paso is jumping from \$1.5 billion to \$10 billion. The facility is set to be operational in 2028 with a planned power capacity of one gigawatt.

Construction began back in October, and the increase comes as part of Meta's broader AI infrastructure push – the company has budgeted up to \$135 billion in capital projects this year alone.

The site is expected to create 300 permanent jobs and bring in over 4,000 construction workers during peak build-out. To support the power demand, Meta is committing to add more than 5,000 megawatts of renewable energy to the regional grid.

On the water front – which is a sensitive issue in Texas – Meta will launch eight water restoration projects and is partnering with the nonprofit DigDeep to provide fresh water to over 100 households. The data center itself will use a closed-loop liquid cooling system that recycles water, with expected consumption comparable to a typical golf course in the area.

Massive investment, impressive renewable energy commitments – but also a reminder of just how resource-hungry the AI boom really is. Thoughts?

Comments

u/stjohns_jester • 2 points • 2026-03-27 18:49 UTC

> MASSIVE CLEAN ENERGY PUSH

... a few "restoration" projects to help about 100 homes is not MASSIVE

u/BIGPOTHEAD • 2 points • 2026-03-27 17:58 UTC

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COUGHBULLSHITCOUGH

u/DZello • 3 points • 2026-03-27 16:35 UTC

Why build those things in hot places? I just don't understand.

u/sqrllymon • 2 points • 2026-03-27 18:34 UTC

5000 Mw = 5 GW

u/DZello • 1 points • 2026-03-27 20:22 UTC

I suspect they'll keep 1GW of solar for their use, and will divert 5GW to the grid when sun is shining. They'll deploy batteries for the datacenter.

They're not giving 5GW for no reason: they're probably just producing 5x more to cover safely their needs.

u/SuperNovaSniper • 1 points • 2026-03-27 17:21 UTC

The government there is already bought and paid for.

u/FutureStackReviews • 2 points • 2026-03-27 16:14 UTC

\$135B in capital projects in a single year is wild. For context, that's more than most countries' entire annual defense budgets. The water angle is interesting too — closed-loop liquid cooling and partnering with a nonprofit for water restoration. Feels like they learned from the backlash other data center projects got for draining local water supplies.

u/Ontain • 3 points • 2026-03-27 17:29 UTC

It's the increased electricity bills that are still the problem

u/AutoModerator • 1 points • 2026-03-27 15:52 UTC

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